GLASSHOUSE

PRICELESS GIFTS

The latest round of the e-auction of various gifts given to Prime Minister Narendra Modi ends on October 31. On the anvil are a badminton racket autographed by K. Srikanth for Rs 5.4 lakh, a seated Buddha in wood for Rs 1.8 lakh and a jersey autographed by the men's hockey team of the 2022 Commonwealth Games at Rs 3.2 lakh. The star item is a Paresh Maity painting of the Varanasi ghat, the price of which has gone up to Rs 74 lakh from Rs 64 lakh on October 2. An aluminium javelin gifted to the PM, initially priced at Rs 3.34 lakh, is also going at around Rs 15 lakh. However, a week before the auction, the response has been tepid as the number of items yet to receive a bid runs in hundreds. The Rs 22.5 crore worth of proceeds of the past three rounds of the auction between 2019 and 2021 went to Namami Gange. Hope, more's added to the kitty.



Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

A Fond Tie

RANJAN RAHI



At a time of feuding *chacha-bhatijas*—from the Pawars in Maharashtra to the Paswans in Bihar—one uncle-nephew duo are doing just fine. We are talking of Bihar chief minister **Nitish Kumar** and his deputy **Tejashwi Yadav**. On October 21, in response to the BJP's snide comments on their relationship, Nitish insisted that Tejashwi was everything to him. "*Hum log saath kaam kar rahe hain. Hum logon ke liye yeh bachcha sab kuchh hai* (We're working together. This child is everything to us)," he said, putting a gentle hand on Tejashwi's shoulder. Wonder what 33-year-old Tejashwi thought of being called a child.



ANI

POSTER PM

Prime Minister **Akhilesh Yadav**? Samajwadi Party workers are expressing that fond hope by putting posters to the effect outside party HQ, or releasing video statements urging for the same. Akhilesh himself has said you don't become PM because someone's put posters. Many in the party, though, would rather that the SP workers focused on ensuring Akhilesh becomes CM next time, an opportunity he missed in 2022.

Garba Diplomacy



In recent times, Muslims have been denied entry to some garba venues during Navratri. But this year, **Harsh Sanghavi**, the Gujarat minister of state for home affairs, did garba with IPS officer Safin Hasan, the deputy commissioner, traffic, in Ahmedabad. On October 19, the Gujarat High Court even sentenced four police officers to 14 days prison for publicly flogging five Muslim men they accused of throwing stones at a crowd during a Navratri event in Kheda last year. Sanghavi had lauded the state police for their action then. Now it's time for reaching out.

SILENCE PLEASE

Even though the Congress is sitting pretty in Karnataka after its emphatic win in the May assembly polls, partymen can't resist speculating about a change of guard. On October 20, Ashok Pattan, the chief whip, brought up the subject of a mid-term reshuffle. Then, MLA Basavaraj Shivaganga claimed that the 70-odd first-time MLAs will back deputy chief minister **D.K. Shivakumar** as chief minister. Shivakumar, also the PCC president, responded with a gag order, forbidding MLAs from publicly airing views on such issues.



HARDIK CHHABRA

Kaushik Deka with Avishek Ghosh Dastidar, Prashant Srivastava, Jumana Shah, Ajay Sukumaran and Amitabh Srivastava